



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Ref:	012	Author:	D Bibby	Date:	05.02.2024
Topic:	OFFICE SAFETY				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Storage:

A common problem found in offices is a lack of space. But a lack of space should not be used as an excuse to improperly store boxes, copier paper, etc.

Storage of Office Materials:

- Keep all storage of combustible materials (cardboard, paper) to an absolute minimum as they can pose both a fire and trip hazard
- Never store combustibles near electrical outlets
- Place heavier objects on lower shelves
- Ensure all shelves are sturdy and will be able to handle the load
- Never block hallways, doors, and stairwells with stored office materials
- There should always be clear access to electrical panels, fire extinguishers and fire call points

Scheduled Cleaning:

- It is a good idea to schedule a few days a year to go through all your paper files and purge unneeded documents
- Remove unnecessary objects/supplies/ books from shelving units
- Assess if you need more shelving space and order/install what is needed to eliminate floor storage
- Take the time to clean and sanitise your workstation as needed
- Keyboards and telephones, in particular, should be cleaned and sanitised

Common Office Injuries:

- Slips, Trips and Falls are the most common cause of office injuries:
- Slipping on wet/slick floors (Clean up any spills immediately)
- Tripping over electrical cords/wires, open cabinet doors (Secure cords/ drawers)
- Damaged flooring (Report any loose tiles, frayed/torn carpeting ect.)
- Objects stored on the floor (Utilise shelf/desk space wherever possible)
- Using a chair/box for a stepladder (Always use a stepladder)
- Struck By or Striking Objects:
- Bumping into doors, open drawers etc.
- Bumping into other people while walking
- Struck by suddenly opened doors or falling objects
- Overexertion and Strains:
- Picking up a load incorrectly
- Repetitive Stress injuries resulting from your workstation

**Discussion Points**

Do you see any potential hazards where you work?

Are there any ideas you have to reduce an accident within the office?

Have you used any unsafe equipment in the office?